

Word family: **own / owns / owned / owning / owner / ownership**

Base word: own

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, **pronoun/determiner**, and **verb**

Related forms:

* **own** (adj./det./pron.) — 自己的；自己的東西

* **own** (v.) — 擁有；承認

* **owner** (n.) — 擁有人；物主

* **ownership** (n.) — 所有權；擁有；承擔責任

* **co-owner** (n.) — 共同擁有人

* **homeowner** (n.) — 業主；自置居所人士

* **business owner** (n.) — 商戶 / 企業擁有人

* **state-owned / privately owned** — 國有的 / 私人擁有的

* **own up** — 坦白承認；認錯

* **take ownership of** — 承擔責任；取得所有權

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **my own / your own**

* **on my own**

* **of my own**

* **own something**

* **own a house / company**

* **own up to**

* **own your mistakes**

* **own the decision**

* **take ownership**

* **ownership of property**

* **sense of ownership**

* **privately owned**

* **state-owned**

* **owner of**

* **business owner**

Meaning in this passage

> Even now, I respect people more when they can **own their mistakes** instead of pretending nothing happened.

Here, **own** is figurative.

It means:

accept responsibility for something you did wrong and openly acknowledge it — 承認並承擔自己的錯誤

The speaker admires people who do not deny or hide their mistakes, but instead admit them and take responsibility.

中文翻譯：

直到現在，我都會更加尊重那些願意**承認並承擔自己的錯誤**、而不是假裝甚麼都沒發生的人。

So here:

own your mistake = 坦白承認錯誤是自己造成的，並願意承擔責任

1. **own (自己的) — 自己的**

Core possessive sense.

Practice 1

> I brought my **own** laptop.

我帶了**自己的**手提電腦。

Practice 2

> Everyone should have their **own** opinion.

每個人都應有**自己的**看法。

Practice 3

> She has her **own** room.

她有**自己的**房間。

MCQ-ready definition:

own = 屬於某人自己，而不是屬於其他人的

2. **my own / your own / his own — 我自己的 / 你自己的 / 他自己的**

Practice 1

> I want to make my **own** decision.

我想作出**自己的決定**。

Practice 2

> You need to find your **own** way.

你需要找到**自己的方法**。

MCQ-ready definition:

someone's own = 特別強調某物、選擇或想法屬於該人自己

3. **of my own / of your own** — 自己擁有的

Practice 1

> I'd like a place **of my own**.

我想有一個**屬於自己的地方**。

Practice 2

> She started a business **of her own**.

她開了一盤**自己的生意**。

MCQ-ready definition:

of one's own = 由某人自己擁有或建立的

4. **on my own** — 獨自；靠自己

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> I finished the project **on my own**.

我**獨自 / 靠自己**完成了項目。

Practice 2

> She lives ****on her own****.

她****獨居****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on one's own = 沒有其他人陪同或幫助，獨自做某事****

5. ****own (verb : 擁有) — 擁有****

A major verb sense.

Practice 1

> She ****owns a flat****.

她****擁有一個單位****。

Practice 2

> The company ****owns several buildings****.

公司****擁有幾棟大樓****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own something = 在法律或實際上擁有某物的所有權****

6. ****own a house / car / company — 擁有房屋 / 汽車 / 公司****

Practice 1

> They ****own their home****.

他們****擁有自己的住所****。

Practice 2

> He ****owns a small company****.

他****擁有一家小公司****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own X = 對 X 有正式所有權****

7. ****be owned by — 由.....擁有****

Practice 1

> The building is ****owned by**** the university.

這棟建築****由大學擁有****。

Practice 2

> The restaurant is ****owned by**** a local family.

這間餐廳****由一個本地家庭擁有****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be owned by X = 某物的所有權屬於 X****

8. ****privately owned — 私人擁有的****

Practice 1

> The company is ****privately owned****.

這家公司是****私人擁有的****。

Practice 2

> The land is ****privately owned****.

這片土地屬於****私人所有****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****privately owned = 由私人個體或私人機構擁有，而不是政府擁有****

9. ****state-owned — 國有的；國營的****

Practice 1

> It is a **state-owned company**.

這是一家**國有企業**。

Practice 2

> The railway is **state-owned**.

這條鐵路由**國家擁有**。

MCQ-ready definition:

state-owned = 由政府或國家擁有的

10. **owner — 擁有人；物主**

Practice 1

> The **owner** of the shop was very friendly.

店鋪的**店主 / 擁有人**很友善。

Practice 2

> Who is the **owner** of this car?

誰是這輛車的**車主**？

MCQ-ready definition:

owner = 擁有某物、企業或資產的人

11. **business owner — 企業 / 商戶擁有人**

Practice 1

> She is a small **business owner**.

她是一位小型**企業主**。

Practice 2

> Local **business owners** attended the meeting.

本地**商戶東主**參加了會議。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****business owner = 擁有並通常經營某間公司的個人****

12. ****homeowner — 業主；自置居所人士****

Practice 1

> The scheme helps first-time ****homeowners****.

這個計劃幫助首次置業的****業主****。

Practice 2

> Many ****homeowners**** are worried about repair costs.

很多****業主****都擔心維修費用。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****homeowner = 擁有自己住宅的人****

13. ****ownership (所有權) — 所有權****

Practice 1

> The document proves ****ownership**** of the property.

該文件證明物業的****所有權****。

Practice 2

> ****Ownership**** was transferred to the buyer.

****所有權****被轉移給買家。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****ownership = 合法擁有某物的狀態或權利****

14. **ownership of property / shares — 物業 / 股份所有權**

Practice 1

> **Ownership of the land** is disputed.

土地的**所有權**存在爭議。

Practice 2

> The records show **ownership of the shares**.

紀錄顯示股份的**擁有情況**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ownership of X = 對 X 的正式擁有權

15. **own (figurative : 承認 / 認領自己的行為) — 承認 ; 承擔**

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I respect people who can **own their mistakes**.

我尊重那些願意**承認並承擔自己錯誤**的人。

Practice 2

> She **owned her mistake** and apologised.

她**承認自己的錯誤並承擔責任**，然後道歉。

Practice 3

> He needs to **own what he did**.

他需要**承認並為自己的行為負責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

own a mistake/action = openly accept that it was yours and take responsibility for it

16. ****own your mistakes — 承認並承擔自己的錯誤****

Practice 1

> Good leaders ****own their mistakes****.

好的領袖會****承認並承擔自己的錯誤****。

Practice 2

> It's difficult, but you have to ****own your mistakes****.

雖然很難，但你必須****為自己的錯誤負責****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own your mistakes = 不推卸責任，坦白承認錯誤是自己造成的****

17. ****own your actions — 為自己的行為負責****

Practice 1

> You need to ****own your actions****.

你需要****為自己的行為負責****。

Practice 2

> He finally ****owned his actions**** instead of blaming others.

他終於****承擔自己的行為責任****，而不是怪別人。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own your actions = 承認行為是自己作出的，並接受其後果****

18. ****own a decision — 承擔自己的決定****

Practice 1

> If you make the decision, you should ****own it****.

如果決定是你作的，就應該****承擔它的責任****。

Practice 2

> The manager **owned the decision** and accepted the consequences.

經理**承擔了這項決定的責任**，並接受後果。

MCQ-ready definition:

own a decision = 承認某項決定是自己作出的，並願意承擔結果

19. **own up** — 坦白承認；認錯

A major phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> He finally **owned up**.

他終於**坦白認錯**。

Practice 2

> Nobody wanted to **own up** to the mistake.

沒有人願意**承認那個錯誤是自己造成的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

own up = informal: 坦白承認自己做了錯事或負有責任

20. **own up to something** — 承認某事

Practice 1

> She **owned up to the mistake**.

她**坦白承認了錯誤**。

Practice 2

> He refused to **own up to what he had done**.

他拒絕**承認自己做過的事**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own up to X = 坦白承認 X 是自己做的或自己需要負責的****

21. ****ownership (責任感 ; 主動承擔) — 承擔責任 ; 主人翁意識****

A major figurative business/workplace extension.

Practice 1

> She took ****ownership of the mistake****.

她****承擔了錯誤的責任****。

Practice 2

> Employees are encouraged to take ****ownership of their work****.

公司鼓勵員工對自己的工作****主動負責****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****ownership = 對某件工作、決定或結果主動承擔責任的態度****

22. ****take ownership of something — 主動承擔責任****

Practice 1

> He ****took ownership of the problem**** instead of blaming the team.

他沒有怪責團隊，而是****主動承擔問題的責任****。

Practice 2

> Managers should ****take ownership of their decisions****.

經理應該****為自己的決定負責****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****take ownership of X = 主動承認自己對 X 有責任，並負責處理或改善****

23. ****sense of ownership — 主人翁意識 ; 擁有感****

Practice 1

> Giving students choices creates a **sense of ownership**.

讓學生有選擇可以培養**主人翁意識**。

Practice 2

> Team members developed a strong **sense of ownership** over the project.

團隊成員對項目建立了強烈的**投入感和責任感**。

MCQ-ready definition:

sense of ownership = 覺得某件事是自己的一部分，因此更願意投入和負責的感覺

24. **own** (接受 / 展現自己的身份或特質) — 坦然接受；認同

A modern figurative extension.

Practice 1

> She learned to **own her style**.

她學會了**自信地接受並展現自己的風格**。

Practice 2

> He finally **owned who he was**.

他終於**坦然接受真正的自己**。

MCQ-ready definition:

own a quality/identity = 自信而坦然地接受並表達自己的特質或身份

25. **own it** — 承認吧 / 自信駕馭它 / 做好它

Highly context-dependent modern expression.

Practice 1

> You made the mistake, so **own it**.

錯是你犯的，就**承認並負責吧**。

Practice 2

> If you're going to wear something bold, **own it**.

如果你要穿得大膽，就要**自信地駕馭它**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own it = depending on context, fully accept responsibility for something or confidently embrace it****

26. **own (徹底勝過 / 壓制 , informal) — 完全壓倒 ; 完勝**

Informal, especially gaming/internet/sports speech.

Practice 1

> Their team totally **owned us** in the second half.

他們下半場完全**壓制了我們**。

Practice 2

> She **owned the debate**.

她在辯論中表現得**完全壓倒全場**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own someone/something = informal: perform much better than someone or dominate a situation****

This is informal and context-dependent.

27. **owned (informal : 被完全擊敗 / 出醜) — 被完勝 ; 被壓制**

Practice 1

> We got completely **owned**.

我們被**徹底打敗**。

Practice 2

> He got **owned** in the argument.

他在爭論中被對方**完全壓住**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get owned = informal: be decisively defeated, outperformed, or made to look foolish

28. **own goal** — 烏龍球

A fixed sports compound.

Practice 1

> He scored an **own goal**.

他射入了一球**烏龍球**。

Practice 2

> The match was decided by an **own goal**.

比賽因一球**烏龍球**而定勝負。

MCQ-ready definition:

own goal = 球員意外把球射入自己球隊的龍門

29. **own goal** (figurative : 自擺烏龍 ; 害到自己) — 自招損失的行為

Practice 1

> The careless comment was a political **own goal**.

那句不小心的評論是一個**自擺烏龍的錯誤**。

Practice 2

> Cancelling the service turned into an **own goal** for the company.

取消該服務最後變成公司的一次**自招損失**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****own goal = figurative: 本來想達成目標，結果自己的行動反而傷害自己****

30. ****on your own terms — 按自己的方式 / 條件****

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 1

> She wanted to succeed ****on her own terms****.

她想****按自己的方式****取得成功。

Practice 2

> He left the company ****on his own terms****.

他****按照自己的決定和條件****離開公司。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on your own terms = 按照自己選擇的方式、原則或條件，而不是別人強加的方式****

Important distinction 1: ****own vs have****

****have****

very broad possession.

****own****

specifically emphasizes ownership.

> I have a car.

我有一輛車。

> I own a car.

那輛車是****我的資產 / 我擁有所有權****。

You can ****have**** something temporarily without owning it.

Important distinction 2: ****own vs belong to****

They describe the same ownership relationship from opposite directions.

> I own the house.

我擁有這間屋。

> The house belongs to me.

這間屋屬於我。

Important distinction 3: ****my own vs my****

****my****

ordinary possession.

****my own****

adds emphasis: mine personally, independently.

> my room

我的房間

> my own room

****我自己獨有的****房間

Important distinction 4: ****on your own vs by yourself****

They overlap strongly.

****on your own****

can mean:

* alone,

* independently, without help.

by yourself

often emphasizes physically alone or doing something without help.

> I did it on my own.

我靠自己完成。

Often carries a stronger independence nuance.

Important distinction 5: **own a mistake vs admit a mistake**

Very relevant to your passage.

admit a mistake

acknowledge that you made it.

own a mistake

acknowledge it **and accept responsibility for it**.

So:

> admit = 承認

> own = 承認 + 不推卸責任

That extra responsibility nuance is crucial.

Important distinction 6: **own your mistake vs apologise**

own the mistake

accept responsibility.

apologise

express regret to the affected person.

A strong apology often includes both:

1. own the mistake
2. apologise for its impact

Important distinction 7: ****own up vs admit****

****admit****

neutral standard.

****own up****

more informal and often suggests someone was previously hiding or avoiding responsibility.

> He admitted the mistake.

他承認錯誤。

> He finally owned up.

他終於坦白認錯。

Important distinction 8: ****own vs take responsibility****

****own the mistake****

more conversational/modern.

****take responsibility for the mistake****

more explicit and formal.

Meaning is very close in this context.

Important distinction 9: ****ownership literal vs figurative****

Literal

> ownership of a house

房屋所有權

Figurative

> ownership of a problem

對問題主動承擔責任

Same metaphor:

treat the responsibility as “yours” rather than pushing it onto someone else

Important distinction 10: **take ownership vs take control**

take ownership

accept responsibility.

take control

gain authority/manage what happens.

> take ownership of a mistake

承擔錯誤責任

> take control of the project

接管項目

They can occur together, but are not the same.

Important distinction 11: **own it has multiple senses**

Responsibility

> You were wrong. Own it.

承認並負責。

Confidence

> Wear the outfit and own it.

自信地駕馭它。

Performance

> She owned the stage.

她完全掌控 / 震住全場。

Context decides.

Important distinction 12: **own = dominate is informal**

> They owned the match.

This is casual language meaning:

****完全壓制 / 表現遠勝對方****

It should not be used in formal academic writing unless quoting or deliberately using informal style.

Important distinction 13: **owner vs holder**

****owner****

has legal/property ownership.

****holder****

possesses or officially holds something.

> owner of a house

房屋擁有人

> passport holder

護照持有人

A holder does not always own the underlying thing.

Important distinction 14: ****ownership vs possession****

****ownership****

legal right to own.

****possession****

having physical custody/control.

Someone can possess something without owning it.

Important distinction 15: ****own goal literal vs figurative****

Sports

score against your own team.

Figurative

do something that harms your own interests.

Both share the idea:

****your own action damages your own side****

Family-extension note

****Own**** develops from the core idea:

****something is yours****

That branches naturally into:

1. ****personal possession/emphasis****

* my own

* of my own

2. ****independence****

* on my own

3. **legal possession**

* own a house

* owner

* ownership

4. **responsibility**

* own your mistake

* take ownership

5. **confession**

* own up

6. **self-acceptance/confidence**

* own who you are

* own it

7. **informal dominance**

* own the game

* get owned

8. **fixed compounds**

* own goal

For your passage, the key metaphor is:

If the mistake is “yours,” don’t push it away—own it.

That means accepting both the fact of the mistake and the responsibility attached to it.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
own (possessive)	自己的	belonging personally	
my own	我自己的	emphatic possession	

of my own	屬於我自己的	personal possession	
on my own	獨自 / 靠自己	independence	
own (verb)	擁有	legal/actual possession	
be owned by	由.....擁有	passive ownership	
privately owned	私人擁有的	private ownership	
state-owned	國有的	government ownership	
owner	擁有人；物主	person who owns	
business owner	企業主	owns business	
homeowner	業主	owns home	
ownership	所有權	right of possession	
own a mistake	承認並承擔錯誤	responsibility	
own your actions	為自己的行為負責	accountability	
own a decision	承擔決定責任	accept consequences	
own up	坦白認錯	confess	
own up to X	承認 X	admit wrongdoing	
take ownership of X	主動承擔 X	responsibility	
sense of ownership	主人翁意識	investment/responsibility	
own who you are	坦然接受自己	self-acceptance	
own it	承擔 / 自信駕馭	context-dependent	
own someone	完全壓制某人	informal dominance	
get owned	被完勝	informal defeat	
own goal	烏龍球	sports	
own goal (figurative)	自擺烏龍	self-defeating act	
on your own terms	按自己的方式	autonomy	

For your original sentence

> Even now, I respect people more when they can ****own their mistakes**** instead of pretending nothing happened.

Here:

****own their mistakes** = 不逃避、不甩鍋、不裝作沒事，而是承認「這是我做錯的」並願意承擔責任

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 直到現在，我都會更加尊重那些願意****承認並承擔自己錯誤****、而不是假裝甚麼都沒發生的人。

The key distinction is:

> ****admit a mistake**** = 承認錯了

> ****own a mistake**** = 承認錯了，而且****不推卸責任，願意承擔後果****

That extra layer of accountability is exactly why ****own**** is the stronger word in this passage.